CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A key technique that creates dramatic irony is: 1

(a) the audience knowing the rhymes are harmless
(b) a lost letter
(c) a hidden twin
(d) a surprise villain

2. If the Martians had been wise readers, which outcome is likely? 1

(a) they would write a book
(b) they would retreat anyway
(c) they would see the rhymes as harmless and might attack
(d) they would befriend Earth immediately

3. The relationship between ignorance and fear is shown by: 1

(a) the book's colour **(b)** the Martians' retreat
(c) the library's size **(d)** the Historian's speech

4. The play's 'time distance' (future historian) serves to: 1

(a) confuse the plot
(b) create horror
(c) add comic detachment and reassure the audience
(d) explain science

5. The play can be read as a comment on: 1

(a) misinformation and its effects on decisions
(b) farming
(c) trade
(d) space travel

6. Which word best describes the Martians' mission before the book? 1

(a) peaceful **(b)** well-informed **(c)** cautious **(d)** overconfident

7. Which statement best expresses the moral? 1

(a) aliens are evil
(b) force wins wars
(c) informed understanding is the basis of peace
(d) books are useless

8. Which character trait of Think-Tank drives the comedy? 1

(a) overconfidence without understanding **(b)** cruelty
(c) honesty **(d)** laziness

9. The proverb 'Fools rush in where angels fear to tread' applies to: 1

(a) the book
(b) the library
(c) the Martians' plan to invade without understanding
(d) the Historian

10. Which of these is a valid criticism of the play? 1

(a) it has too many acts
(b) it is too long
(c) its humour relies on simple mockery and a convenient coincidence
(d) it is too violent

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the writer maintain a balance between humour and message? 2

12. Why might the play's optimism be called naive? 2

13. How does the play deal with the theme of fear? 2

14. What is the function of the Historian's closing remarks? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the role of the framing narrative. 3

16. Evaluate whether the play is only a comedy or also a serious warning. 3

17. How does the play critique blind obedience in hierarchies? 3

OR

How does the play address the theme of cultural misunderstanding? 3

18. Examine the role of language and interpretation in the plot. 3

OR

Discuss the educational value of the play for school students. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on 'The value of reading in a world of misinformation', using the play. 5

OR

How does the play use anticlimax and bathos? 5

20. Compare 'The Book That Saved the Earth' with 'Footprints Without Feet' as science fiction. 5

OR

Write a review of the play for the school magazine. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

Mastermind